Max Cobbett

Senior / Lead Software Engineer

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Currently in Johannesburg, South Africa · Open to relocating internationally

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Summary

Senior / Lead software engineer with 10+ years building web applications, services, and APIs for banks, fintechs, and back-office platforms — most recently stabilizing and modernizing systems under real production constraints: untangling legacy architecture, driving defect rates toward zero, and mentoring engineers along the way.

Technical Skills

Languages: TypeScript, C#, JavaScript

Frontend: Angular, Astro, Tailwind CSS, AG Grid, BPMN.io

Backend: .NET, ASP.NET Core, ASP.NET, Node.js

Data & Infrastructure: SQL Server, Microsoft Azure DevOps, Docker, MongoDB, Jenkins, Firebase, Cloudflare

Testing: Vitest, Jest, Karma, CodeceptJS, MSTest, NUnit, xUnit

AI-Assisted Development: Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor

Experience

Lead IT Developer — BNP Paribas CIB APAC, Hong Kong *Aug 2024 – Jun 2026*

Directed the rewrite of a BPMN-driven workflow-preparation application supporting regulatory reporting, used by 50-100 internal users, driving its technical direction and mentoring 2-3 engineers.

- Replaced the application's core workflow-processing engine, removing a major source of technical debt and modernizing the architecture.
- Rebuilt the sanitization and parsing pipeline for JSON content embedded in XML, reducing parsing errors to effectively zero.
- Implemented a depth-first search traversal algorithm for workflow/graph processing, significantly speeding up execution.
- Improved rendering performance of a properties panel by 400%+ through browser profiling and targeted library optimizations.
- Led incremental Angular upgrades from v14 to v21, migrating the application to Signals and a zoneless architecture (removing Zone.js) for more predictable change detection and improved runtime performance.
- Reduced production bugs and regressions dramatically through disciplined refactoring and feature work, reinforced by a new automated test suite (Jest/Vitest, CodeceptJS).
- Enforced consistent code style and modern tooling across the team to raise code quality and collaboration.

Senior Software Engineer — Quantifeed HK Ltd, Hong Kong *Mar 2019 – Aug 2024*

Developed and maintained a white-labelled portfolio management and administration application.

- Built reusable Angular library components and services adopted across 15+ white-labelled client deployments.
- Delivered a direct debit authorization integration into a ASP.NET Core web server for a mobile client app spanning 3-4 partner institutions.
- Implemented configurable content security policy middleware for the ASP.NET Core web server, strengthening the platform's security posture.
- Contributed to product direction using domain knowledge, translating requirements into efficient, reusable components and faster feature delivery.
- Gained hands-on Azure DevOps experience updating CI/CD pipelines and maintaining the development environment.

Software Engineer — Entelect, South Africa *May 2016 – Feb 2019*

Developed, maintained, and tested REST APIs for Investec's investment administration platform.

- Built and maintained trading APIs for Investec's asset management platform using ASP.NET.
- Maintained and upgraded a white-labelled onboarding Angular application backed by a Node.js server.
- Built a proof-of-concept fund-switch feature, later incorporated into a newly built successor application.

Projects

Old Speckled Men

A sports team management app for a football team. Built with Angular, hosted on Firebase, connected to Firestore.

Porto Engineering

A small-business website focussed on customer acquisition and marketing. Built with Astro, hosted on Cloudflare.

Education

Bachelor of Computer and Information Sciences — Monash University (South African campus)
Graduated: 2015